

Foldable cells

MIT researchers have come up with a foldable solution to solar power generation

Social network wars

LinkedIn now becomes No.2 social network in the US, surpassing MySpace

Industry Connect

Chrome for Developers

We spoke to Nikhil Rungta, Country Marketing Head, Google India. He shared his insights on Chrome as a product, the innovation that drives it, and more...

■ How does Google Chrome differ from other browsers?

NR: We're not in the business of making comparisons with other browsers. There are already great options out there today and users will decide which browser is best for them. But here are a few things we'd like you to remember about Google Chrome. It's simple and easy to use: we've designed Google Chrome to be as unobtrusive as possible, taking up the minimum amount of space on your screen, allowing you to search and browse all from the address bar. Its sophisticated technology also makes Google Chrome fast and stable. For example, we've designed each tab to act as a stand-alone browser. So if you have lots of tabs open at once, and one crashes, they don't all go down. And its powerful new JavaScript engine, V8, helps speed up your web applications.

■ How fast is Chrome growing?

NR: Chrome has real momentum. Browser share has increased rapidly to 30.2% as of July 2011 (source: Weekly, StatCounter). At Google I/O in 2010, Chrome had 70M active users, at this year's I/O we announced we more than doubled to 160M (May 2011).

■ Why did you launch the Chrome Web Store?

NR: Google launched its Chrome Web Store in Dec 2010 and to date, we're seeing 100s of thousands of app installs a day (June 2011). We believe it should be really simple and easy for users to discover web apps and for developers to reach a large audience. The Chrome Web Store is an open marketplace to help users search,

find and use the best apps around the web - including those for education, entertainment, gaming, news, productivity and more. For developers, they are already seeing some great results.

■ What about your relationship with Mozilla/Firefox?

NR: We remain great supporters of Firefox. After all it was Mozilla that kicked off most of the innovation we have seen in browsers over the last few years and proved that you can build a mass market software product using open source technology and through collaboration. Competitive open source projects, like Chrome or Firefox, are good for the industry because they allow developers to make advances and share them quickly. We continue to have a valuable partnership with Mozilla. Mozilla disclosed in September 2008 that we had just closed a three-year deal with them and we were pleased about that then and remain so now.

■ Do you think Chrome Frame is still useful on Internet Explorer?

NR: We welcome innovation in the browser space that provides richer features for users and greater support of standards like HTML5. Having great competitors makes us all work harder and at the end of the day our users benefit from that. With that said, non-admin Chrome Frame runs a helper process at startup to assist with loading the Chrome Frame plug-in into Internet Explorer.

The helper process is designed to consume almost no system resources while running. Once installed, non-admin users will have the same no-



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friction experience that admin users of Chrome Frame have today. You can try it yourself by installing the new non-admin version of Chrome Frame – this is now available in our developer channel and is coming to stable channel very soon.

■ Where will Chrome be in five years?

NR: The Chrome team will continue to aim to provide the best web experience for our users and will continue to focus on our core 3 tenets - speed, simplicity and security. Beyond that, the Chrome team has also always been focused on spurring innovation and pushing the web forward for all (eg., our Chrome experiments and the nature of us being open source). With the recent launch of Chrome OS, we're also pushing a new model of computing, which is a long-term endeavour. ■